

LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIO REDESIGN: A NEW VISION

Transforming Operational Dashboards into Comprehensive Leadership Tools

Leadership Portfolio Redesign – Design Rationale

Objective

The primary aim of this redesign was to evolve the Leadership Portfolio from a predominantly metric-focused operational dashboard into a compelling, narrative-driven career artifact. This transformation intends to create a document that employees feel proud to share with mentors, managers, and their future selves.

The original dashboard-style layout gave all metrics equal visual precedence, resulting in cognitive overload and undermining the emotional connection with the document. My redesign places emphasis on storytelling, information hierarchy, readability, and portability, all while preserving the integrity of the robust, physics-grade data system at its core.

Key Questions

The redesigned portfolio is structured to answer four pivotal questions within the first minute of reading:

1. **How did I perform this month?**
 - This section provides a concise overview of the employee's achievements and contributions over the past month, highlighting key performance indicators and milestones.
2. **What meaningful work did I contribute?**
 - This part of the portfolio narrates the impactful projects and tasks the employee has undertaken, showcasing their contributions and the value they added to their team or organization.
3. **How did I grow professionally?**
 - Here, the focus is on the employee's professional development, detailing the skills acquired, training completed, and any feedback received that contributed to their growth.
4. **Where am I headed next?**

- This section outlines the employee's future goals and aspirations, providing a roadmap for their career trajectory and highlighting opportunities for further development.

Design Elements

Storytelling

The redesign incorporates storytelling elements to make the document more engaging and relatable. By weaving the employee's experiences and achievements into a cohesive narrative, the portfolio becomes more than just a collection of data points; it becomes a story of personal and professional growth.

Information Hierarchy

To reduce overload, a clear information hierarchy should be established. Key insights are prioritized and presented prominently, while supplementary details are organized logically. This approach ensures that the most important information is immediately accessible, enhancing readability and comprehension.

Readability

The portfolio design emphasizes clarity and ease of reading. Thoughtful typography choices and strategic use of whitespace improve the overall aesthetic and make the document more inviting to read.

Portability

Recognizing the need for a document that can be easily shared and accessed across different platforms, the redesign ensures that the portfolio is portable. It is optimized for both digital and print formats, allowing employees to share their achievements effortlessly.

In summary, this redesign transforms the Leadership Portfolio into a document that not only communicates performance metrics but also tells the story of the employee's journey, achievements, and future aspirations in an engaging and accessible manner.

2. Core Design Philosophy

The redesign follows a “story-first, evidence-second” philosophy.

Instead of presenting disconnected metric widgets, the portfolio now presents a structured monthly narrative supported by verified evidence. The intent was to make the document feel closer to a personal career pitch deck than a monitoring dashboard.

The design prioritizes:

- Clear emotional signal at the top
- Personal identity and ownership
- Human-readable language
- Progressive disclosure of detailed data
- Reduced cognitive load
- Professional yet personal tone

FOR EXAMPLE

"Strong execution month. Successfully delivered most planned work while improving process discipline and knowledge contribution." should be written first

72 score, 14 IP, 4 KPI, 78%

3. Key Design Decisions

Decision 1 — Narrative- First Executive Summary

I replaced the traditional heavy metric header with a narrative- based executive summary that communicates the employee's monthly story in one clear sentence.

Instead of displaying multiple KPIs immediately, the portfolio opens with a human-readable performance summary such as :

"Strong delivery month with consistent capability growth and meaningful knowledge contributions."

This approach improves emotional engagement and allows employee or mentor to understand the overall performance signal within seconds.

Reason behind this

The assignment repeatedly emphasized avoiding "metric soup." A narrative-first summary creates clarity, hierarchy, and emotional resonance while still allowing metrics to support the story below.

Decision 2 — Human-Centered Language Instead of Internal Jargon

Several internal system terms were replaced with simpler and more portable language.

For Example:

Original Term	Redesigned Term
IP Commits	Original Work
Ritual Score	Engagement
QA Pending	Awaiting Review
Deliverables	Work Delivered

Why I Chose This

The portfolio is designed to follow the employee even outside the organization through its permanent UID. Therefore , the language needed to remain understandable to mentors, future employers, and external readers unfamiliar with PDGMS terminology.

This decision improves portability and makes the portfolio feel like employee’s document rather than an internal company report.

Decision 3 – Visual Hierarchy Based on Story Importance

The redesign intentionally avoids giving equal visual weight to all sections.

The hierarchy used is:

- 1. Executive Summary (largest focus)
- 2. Contribution Highlights
- 3. Capability Growth
- 4. KPI Impact
- 5. Constraints
- 6. Career Trajectory

Contribution and Growth sections receive the most visual emphasis because they contains strongest narrative value and the richest data.

Lower-density sections such as KPI Impact and Constraints are visually compressed or collapsible to reduce cognitive overload.

Reason Behind This is

The original dashboard problem came from presenting every metric equally. By prioritizing narrative-rich sections, the redesign creates a more readable and emotionally coherent experience.

4. Handling the Five Design Challenges

Challenge 1 — The Signal

My Approach

I used a narrative performance signal supported by a secondary composite score.

Example:

“Strong execution month with steady growth across capability areas.”

Supporting data:

- Composite Score: 78/100
- Status: On Track

Reasoning

A sentence creates emotional interpretation while the score provides measurable validation. Using both together balances storytelling and accountability.

Challenge 2 — Story vs Data Ordering

My Approach

Each major section begins with a short narrative paragraph followed by supporting metrics and visual indicators.

Reasoning

Narrative-first ordering makes the document feel personal and reflective, while the supporting metrics preserve the trust and verification. This structure aligns with the “pitch deck” mindset described in the assignment.

Challenge 3 — Six Sections Being Too Heavy

My Approach

I retained all six sections to preserve completeness of data model, but reduced the prominence of the lower-information sections.

Reasoning

Integrity would weaken by removing sections of the portfolio system. Instead, visual hierarchy and progressive disclosure were used to reduce overload while maintaining completeness.

Challenge 4 — Constraint Section Tone

My Approach

The constraint section was reframed as “Operational Challenges Navigated” rather than a negative problem list.

The section focuses on:

- resolution progress
- blocker handling
- organizational learning

rather than the complaints.

Reasoning

Constraints are important diagnostic data, but over-emphasizing them creates anxiety and damages the tone of the portfolio. The redesign presents them professionally and constructively.

Challenge 5 — Identity and Portability

My Approach

The employee’s identity is prominently displayed at the top of the portfolio along with:

- Name
- Role
- Reporting Month
- Portfolio UID

Reasoning

This reinforces ownership and transforms the page into a personal career artifact rather than an internal analytics page.

5. Information Hierarchy Strategy

The redesign uses a layered reading structure:

Layer 1 — Immediate Signal

The employee understands overall monthly performance within 3 seconds.

Layer 2 — Story Blocks

Contribution and capability sections explain the month in narrative form.

Layer 3 – Evidence

Detailed metrics, KPI breakdowns, and constraint data support the narrative.

This structure balances readability with data fidelity.

6. Assumptions Made

The following assumptions were made during the redesign process:

- The employee is the primary audience.
- Mentors and supervisors are secondary readers.
- Most users will spend less than 2 minutes reviewing the portfolio.
- The portfolio should remain understandable outside the organization.
- Narrative summaries are generated server-side and rendered directly by the frontend.
- Mobile responsiveness would be handled in later iterations.

7. What I Would Improve With More Time

If given additional time, I would further explore:

- Interactive monthly timeline navigation
- Expandable evidence panels
- Print-friendly portfolio export
- Mentor sharing mode
- Personalized visual themes
- Better visualization for career runway confidence intervals
- Mobile-first responsive optimization

I would also conduct usability testing with:

- employees
- supervisors
- HR reviewers

to validate whether narrative-first ordering works equally well across all audiences.

8. Conclusion

This redesign shifts the Leadership Portfolio from an operational monitoring interface into a meaningful professional narrative.

The final design emphasizes:

- clarity

- ownership
- dignity
- growth
- storytelling

while preserving the integrity and verifiability of the underlying PDGMS data system.

The goal was not to reduce data, but to structure it in a way that helps employees understand and communicate the story of their work and growth more meaningfully.